

SERVING PLAN 4 SERVING PLAN

Seared Steak

with Cacio e Pepe Polenta, Roasted Zucchini, and Tomatoes

Cacio e pepe is a classic Roman pasta dish made up of cheese (cacio) and pepper (pepe). Here, we swirl cheesy Parmesan and cracked black peppercorns into creamy, quick-cooking polenta paired with roasted garlic. It makes a rich, velvety base for seared steak and roasted summer vegetables. For an extra peppery kick, top with even more Parm and freshly ground black pepper.

25–35 minutes 530 calories per serving

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MEALS WORTH MAKING

Ingredients

- 12 ounces zucchini
- 3 cloves garlic
- ¾ pint grape tomatoes
- 4 steaks
- 1 cup polenta
- 3 packets unsalted butter
- ½ teaspoon cracked black peppercorns
- 2 ounces grated Parmesan cheese

You'll need

olive oil
kosher salt
ground black pepper
aluminum foil
baking sheet
12" large pan
8" medium pot with lid

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking. Trust us—you'll be glad you did!

In Step 2 and Step 3, ground black pepper refers to the kind you have at home (feel free to use sparingly or as desired). We've included cracked black peppercorn, broken into slightly larger pieces, for the polenta.

Cutting meat against the grain ensures tenderness. Find the direction of the grain (muscle fibers) and slice across it, rather than parallel.

USDA recommends cooking beef to 145°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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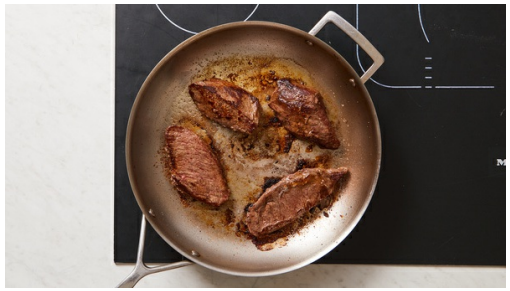
1. Prepare ingredients

Preheat oven to 425°F. Rinse all produce. Quarter **zucchini** lengthwise, then cut crosswise on a diagonal into ½-inch slices, discarding ends. Using the flat side of a knife, gently crush **garlic cloves**. Line a baking sheet with foil.



2. Roast vegetables

On prepared baking sheet, toss **whole grape tomatoes**, **zucchini**, and **crushed garlic** with **1½ tablespoons olive oil**, **½ teaspoon salt**, and **ground black pepper** (see recipe tip). Arrange in a single layer and roast, stirring halfway through to ensure even cooking, until softened, 12–14 minutes total (move on to Step 3, but don't forget to come back!). Once roasted, transfer **crushed garlic** to cutting board and mince.



3. Sear steaks

While vegetables roast, pat **steaks** dry with paper towel and season all over with **1 teaspoon salt** and **ground black pepper** as desired. Heat **1 tablespoon olive oil** in a large pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **steaks** and sear, working in batches and adding oil as needed, until browned and medium rare, 4–6 minutes per side. Transfer **seared steaks** to a plate and set aside to rest.



4. Cook polenta

While steaks sear, in a medium pot, bring **4 cups water** to a near-boil over high heat (it should be just lightly bubbling). Whisk in **polenta** and **1½ teaspoons salt** until smooth. Reduce heat to medium low and cook, whisking constantly, until thickened, about 1 minute (see recipe tip). Remove pot from heat.



5. Finish cacio e pepe polenta

To pot with polenta, still off heat, whisk in **butter**, **cracked black peppercorns**, **roasted garlic**, and **half of Parmesan** until smooth. Cover to keep warm until ready to serve.



6. Plate seared steak

Once rested, cut **steaks** against the grain into ¼-inch slices (see recipe tip). Divide **cacio e pepe polenta** among serving plates, then top with **sliced steak** and **roasted vegetables**. Garnish with **remaining Parmesan** and **ground black pepper** as desired. Enjoy!

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